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Basic Linux Interview Questions and Answers - Part II

By **Avishek Kumar** Under: **Interview Questions** On: **November 23, 2013**

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Continuing the Interview Series, we are giving 10 Questions here, in this article. These questions and the questions in the future articles doesn't necessarily means they were asked in any interview. We are presenting you an interactive learning platform through these kind of posts, which surely will be helpful.

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Basic Linux Interview Questions – 2

Upon the analysis of comments in different forums on last article [11 Basic Linux Interview Questions](#) of this series, it is important to mention here that to bring up a quality article to our readers. We give our time and money, and in return what we expect from you? Nothing. If you can't praise our work, please don't demoralize us from your negative comments.

If you find nothing new in a post, don't forget that for someone it was helpful, and for that he/she was thankful. We can't make everyone happy in each of our article. Hope you readers would take pain to understand this.

Q.1: Which command is used to record a user login session in a file?

- macro
- read
- script
- record
- sessionrecord

Answer : The 'script' command is used to record a user's login session in a file. Script command can be implemented in a shell script or can directly be used in terminal. Here is an example which records everything between script and exit.

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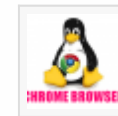
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Let's record the user's login session with script command as shown.

```
[root@tecmint ~]# script my-session-record.txt
Script started, file is my-session-record.txt
```

The content of log file 'my-session-record.txt' can be views as:

```
[root@tecmint ~]# nano my-session-record.txt

script started on Friday 22 November 2013 08:19:01 PM IST
[root@tecmint ~]# ls
^[[0m^[[01;34mBinary^[[0m ^[[01;34mDocuments^[[0m ^[[01;34mMusic^[[0m $
^[[01;34mDesktop^[[0m ^[[01;34mDownloads^[[0m my-session-record.txt ^[[01;34$
```

Q.2: The kernel log message can be viewed using which of the following command?

- dmesg
- kernel
- ls -i
- uname
- None of the above

Answer : The kernel log message can be viewed by executing 'dmesg' command. In the list kernel is not a valid Linux command, 'ls -i' lists the file with inode within the working directory and 'uname' command shows os.

```
[root@tecmint ~]# dmesg

Initializing cgroup subsys cpuset
Initializing cgroup subsys cpu
Linux version 2.6.32-279.el6.i686 (mockbuild@c6b9.bsys.dev.centos.org) (gcc ve
KERNEL supported cpus:
  Intel GenuineIntel
  AMD AuthenticAMD
```

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```
NSC Geode by NSC
Cyrix CyrixInstead
Centaur CentaurHauls
Transmeta GenuineTMx86
Transmeta TransmetaCPU
UMC UMC UMC UMC
Disabled fast string operations
BIOS-provided physical RAM map:
...
```

Q.3: Which command is used to display the release of Linux Kernel?

- `uname -v`
- `uname -r`
- `uname -m`
- `uname -n`
- `uname -o`

Answer : The command '`uname -r`' display the kernel release information. The switch '`-v`', '`-m`', '`-n`', '`-o`' display kernel version, machine hardware name, network node, hostname and operating system, respectively.

```
[root@tecmint ~]# uname -r

2.6.32-279.el6.i686
```

Q.4: Which command is used to identify the types of file?

- ✓ Complete Linux Command Line Cheat Sheet
- ✓ The GNU/Linux Advanced Administration Guide
- ✓ Securing & Optimizing Linux Servers
- ✓ Linux Patch Management: Keeping Linux Up To Date
- ✓ Introduction to Linux – A Hands on Guide
- ✓ Understanding the Linux® Virtual Memory Manager
- ✓ Linux Bible – Packed with Updates and Exercises
- ✓ A Newbie's Getting Started Guide to Linux
- ✓ Linux from Scratch – Create Your Own Linux OS
- ✓ Linux Shell Scripting Cookbook, Second Edition
- ✓ Securing & Optimizing Linux: The Hacking Solution
- ✓ User Mode Linux – Understanding and Administration

:: FOLLOW US ::

- type
- info
- file
- which
- ls

Answer : The 'file' command is used to identify the types of file. The syntax is 'file [option] File_name'.

```
[root@tecmint ~]# file wtop
wtop: POSIX shell script text executable
```

Q.5: Which command locate the binary, source and man page of a command?

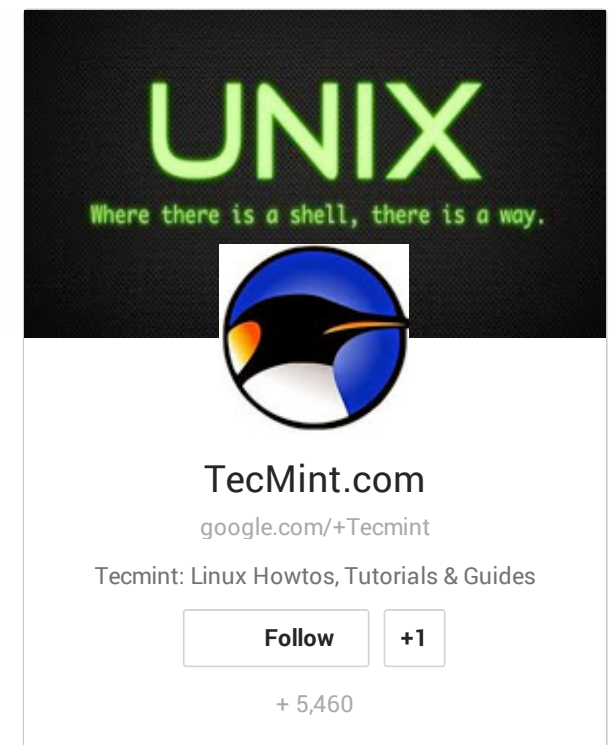
Answer : The 'whereis' command comes to rescue here. The 'whereis' command locate the binary, source, and manual page files for a command.

```
[root@tecmint ~]# whereis /usr/bin/ftp
ftp: /usr/bin/ftp /usr/share/man/man1/ftp.1.gz
```

Q.6: When a user login, which files are called for user profile, by default??

Answer : The '.profile' and '.bashrc' present under home directory are called for user profile by default.

```
[root@tecmint ~]# ls -al
-rw-r--r--. 1 tecmint      tecmint      176 May 11  2012 .bash_profile
-rw-r--r--. 1 tecmint      tecmint      124 May 11  2012 .bashrc
```



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Q.7: The 'resolv.conf' file is a configuration file for?

Answer : The '/etc/resolv.conf' is the configuration file for DNS at client side.

```
[root@tecmint ~]# cat /etc/resolv.conf  
nameserver 172.16.16.94
```

Q.8: Which command is used to create soft link of a file?

- ln
- ln -s
- link
- link -soft
- None of the above

Answer : The 'ln -s' command is used to create soft link of a file in Linux Environment.

```
[root@tecmint ~]# ln -s /etc/httpd/conf/httpd.conf httpd.original.conf
```

Q.9: The command 'pwd' is an alias of command 'passwd' in Linux?

Answer : No! The command 'pwd' is not an alias of command 'passwd' by default. 'pwd' stands for 'print working directory', which shows current directory and 'passwd' is used to change the password of user account in Linux.

```
[root@tecmint ~]# pwd  
  
/home/tecmint
```

```
[root@tecmint ~]# passwd
```

```
Changing password for user root.  
New password:  
Retype new password:
```

Q.10: How will you check pci devices vendor and version on a Linux?

Answer : The Linux command 'lspci' comes to rescue here.

```
[root@tecmint ~]# lspci  
  
00:00.0 Host bridge: Intel Corporation 5000P Chipset Memory Controller Hub (re  
00:02.0 PCI bridge: Intel Corporation 5000 Series Chipset PCI Express x8 Port  
00:04.0 PCI bridge: Intel Corporation 5000 Series Chipset PCI Express x8 Port  
00:06.0 PCI bridge: Intel Corporation 5000 Series Chipset PCI Express x8 Port  
00:08.0 System peripheral: Intel Corporation 5000 Series Chipset DMA Engine (r  
...
```

That's all for now. I hope these above questions might be very helpful to you. In our next weekend we again come-up with some new set of questions. Till then stay healthy, tuned and connected to Tecmint.



Bio



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Avishek Kumar

I am a major in computer science, love to research nix. I love to write codes and scripts, review distros, experiment Foss Technologies, write technical articles, Hack, of course Ethically. I am working as System Administrator (nix) for a NGO.



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29 Responses



Suhail cheroor

November 23, 2013 at 5:57 pm

Thanks ...Very helpful...

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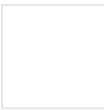


Avishek Kumar

November 25, 2013 at 8:24 pm

welcome@ Suhail cheroor.

REPLY



Ashu

February 13, 2014 at 2:25 pm

very helpfull
thanks
ashu

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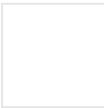


Fernando Souza

November 24, 2013 at 2:42 am

Thanks for the articles, it's so great!!

REPLY



Avishek Kumar

November 25, 2013 at 8:26 pm

Thanks @ Fernando Souza, for your valueable feedback.

REPLY



nilesh khetre

November 24, 2013 at 6:36 am

gr8..

REPLY



Avishek Kumar

November 25, 2013 at 8:28 pm

Thanks @ Nilesh Khetre, for your highly appreciated feedback.

REPLY



Yannick

November 24, 2013 at 9:29 am

There is a mistake (twice) in the question and answer about resolv.conf. The file is wrongly named resolve.conf instead of resolv.conf.

REPLY



Avishek Kumar

November 25, 2013 at 8:33 pm

Thanks @ Yannic for pointing that out. LibreOffice dictionary amended it automatically from resolv.conf to resolve.conf.

Anyway, it has been fixed in the article.

REPLY



durga Prasad

November 24, 2013 at 3:10 pm

Coolllllllll.....

REPLY



Avishek Kumar

November 25, 2013 at 8:35 pm

Thanks @ Durga Prasad. :)

REPLY



saber

November 25, 2013 at 4:47 pm

Thanks! waiting for new items

REPLY



Avishek Kumar

November 25, 2013 at 8:38 pm

Thanks @ saber, for your feedback. we are coming up with next interview article on next saturday.
Till then stay tuned and connected.

REPLY



Shahrin Ishak

November 26, 2013 at 3:35 am

Great article. Thanks Avishek. I have never missed your articles and always archiving it for future reference.

REPLY



Avishek Kumar

November 26, 2013 at 8:15 pm

Thanks @ Shahrin Ishak, Your comment is one of the best honour, i received.

REPLY



SAB

November 26, 2013 at 1:02 pm

Nice list for learning basic Linux commands.

Thanks.

REPLY



Avishek Kumar

November 26, 2013 at 8:16 pm

Thanks @ SAB for your Feedback.

REPLY



Koshal

November 26, 2013 at 7:31 pm

Thanks for that waiting for more question

REPLY



Avishek Kumar

November 26, 2013 at 8:18 pm

sure @ koshal, we are coming up with next article on Interview Question on Next Saturday, and every Saturday.

REPLY



Paul

November 29, 2013 at 4:23 pm

I think answer for Q6 isn't fully correct.

1. ~/.bashrc will run only if user shell is bash, and ~/.bashrc will run after ~/.bash_profile script if it present.

2. There are a lot of scripts may run before ~/.profile script. At first /etc/profile, and then every script in /etc/profile.d/ directory.

At fact ~/.bashrc and ~/.profile are the lastest files which called for user profile.

REPLY



bittu

December 6, 2013 at 7:24 pm

super@@@@@2better to prvide more..

REPLY



Avishek Kumar

January 7, 2014 at 10:29 pm

Thanks @ bittu, we are considering your request.

REPLY



Ankit Sahai

December 16, 2013 at 10:40 pm

very useful..thanks a lot for sharing.

REPLY



Avishek Kumar

January 7, 2014 at 10:29 pm

Welcome @ Ankit Sahil

REPLY

Phani

January 6, 2014 at 2:42 pm

Very much helpful for beginners in Linux

REPLY

Avishek Kumar

January 7, 2014 at 10:30 pm

Nice to hear that it was helpful.
Thanks @ Phani

REPLY

Ashok Dobal

January 7, 2014 at 6:49 pm

Grate dude! very helpful.....

REPLY

Avishek Kumar

January 7, 2014 at 10:31 pm

THanks @ Ashok Dobal, for your Great Response.

REPLY

birendra ram

May 28, 2014 at 8:49 pm

thanks for giving me information

REPLY

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